

Nagios: The System Monitoring Tool You Can Depend On

Enterprise class IT system monitoring of servers, networks and applications is possible with the FOSS tool Nagios. Problems can be identified and remedied long before they become critical and lead to system failures and downtime. Nagios is very versatile as it is platform-independent.

Nagios is a highly powerful open source monitoring tool which helps IT-enabled sectors to provide an early diagnosis of as well as address critical failures in the monitored network. Unknown server breakdowns or any network outages can be reported well in advance before critical business gets affected. The major aspects of the tool are scalability and flexibility. It also provides online reporting of network statistics and by making it the central management system, administrators can detect any anomalies in the network. Early detection and mitigation of such malicious threats can improve the quality of service without affecting the clients.

Nagios is a widely used open source network monitoring software deployed across networks. It keeps track of the hosts and their respective services. It alerts administrators when the system senses any intrusions and malicious

activities. It also completely monitors the IT enabled network, providing online reporting of services, running applications and keeping an eye on whether processes are functioning properly. Once a failure is encountered, the alerts are reported, enabling admins to take proper remedial measures before the entire network shuts down or an outage is experienced by the end users. The infected machines can be isolated from the network so that the security of the network is assured and quality of service is achieved. The algorithm and the functionality of Nagios XI is shown with the help of a service state diagram in Figure 1.

Nagios can be used for cluster management, monitoring Web services and as the central management system, depending on the deployment model. When an agent based system is used for monitoring purposes, it consumes host resources such

